

The Valdosta Times

VOL. 85—NO. 305

Valdosta, Georgia

25 Cents

Daybreak

Valdosta should see partly cloudy skies with a 30 percent chance of thunderstorms in the middle '90s. Complete weather details on page 2-A.

Locally

Pleads Not Guilty

Arraigned in U.S. District Court, in Macon, Wednesday, a Fargo man who avoided murder charges in 1983 on a technicality pleaded not guilty to kidnapping and transferring stolen property.

Randolph Boone, currently serving a 20-year sentence for armed robbery in North Carolina, was indicted by a federal grand jury in June. The charges are connected with the 1983 slaying of Jonathan Mark Wood, 33, who Boone said he met in Jacksonville, Fla. After driving to Fargo, Boone reportedly slit Wood's throat and tied him to a tree behind Boone's father's house.

Boone was charged with murder in Clinch County but the indictment was dropped in 1989 because former Alapaha Circuit District Attorney Lew Barrow failed to respond to Boone's petition for a speedy trial.

The defendant arrived in Macon Aug. 6 from Central Prison in Raleigh, N.C. and will be in the custody of the U.S. Marshall Service in Georgia until his trial, tentatively scheduled for Oct. 9 in Macon.

The case was reopened at the request of the victim's family. Assistant U.S. Attorney Paul McCommon said there is no murder charge applicable under federal law for the crime Boone of which Boone is accused. If convicted, Boone faces a possible life sentence with no chance of parole.

—Kelli Bowman

Briefly

Grape Grapes

SAN FRANCISCO — Two grape growers have been charged with passing off inexpensive wine grapes as premium varieties.

Brothers Nick and Frank Bavaro, who own vineyards and a grape brokerage in Escalon in the San Joaquin Valley, are at the center of a statewide grape scandal.

An indictment charged them with conspiracy, mail and wire fraud and false statements to the United States Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco and Firearms in connection to the sale of wine grapes to seven northern California wineries.

Sound Of Music

LOS ANGELES — To celebrate the silver anniversary of "The Sound of Music," 20th Century Fox will re-release the Oscar-winning musical on Aug. 4, the studio announced Wednesday.

Winner of five Academy Awards, "The Sound of Music" made its debut in 1965 and was a commercial hit, grossing \$57 million over an unprecedented 14-year run.

The soundtrack album, featuring Julie Andrews, sold 10 million copies worldwide.

—The Associated Press

Today's Tips

The Valdosta AARP Chapter 129 meets at the Craig Center 1:20 p.m.

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By KELLI BOWMAN
Times Staff Writer

Lowndes County Commissioners voted in a tax increase at their regular meeting Wednesday night — one slightly lower than expected.

Commissioners had anticipated raising the county millage rate by 1 mill to fund the \$90 million budget for fiscal year 1991 they adopted last month. However, a healthy increase in the property tax digest offset that increase by about 25 percent. The "big digest" is the total of all taxable

property value in the county. The 774 mills average increase raises the county's portion of property tax to 736 mills in incorporated areas and 477 in the county after sales tax and insurance credits. The increase will amount to \$7.75 to \$8.80 more in property tax to Lowndes County landowners for every thousand dollars of taxable property value.

Growth in the county in addition to the revaluation of certain areas contributed to a 7.63 percent increase in the digest in Lowndes

cities and 8.18 percent countywide. The board had only anticipated 3 percent growth.

In other action, commissioners: Authorized the expenditure of approximately \$130,000 to repair the wastewater treatment plant at the Foxborough subdivision in north Lowndes County.

Foxborough residents filled the small meeting room at the Lowndes County Courthouse and the hallway outside, attending the meeting in hopes of encouraging the board to repair the plant that they say pro-

duces an atrocious stench.

Additionally, spokesman Dan Jordan said water from the neighborhood's well system tastes and smells bad and pressure is very low.

Upgrading the 18-year-old plant is included in the county's five-year water and sewer master plan. However, because residents believe the system is in a state of crisis, the board decided to expedite the project.

Richard Thompson with McLaren/Hart Environmental Engineers from Jacksonville, Fla., said it's possible

the repairs, that he estimates will extend the plant's life five years, will take about six months.

Adopted a resolution to place the burden of obtaining an enhanced 911 emergency telephone system on county voters. Registered voters will be able to cast a "yes" or "no" vote in the Nov. 6 general election as to whether they're willing to pay an extra \$1.50 per month in telephone charges for the computer system that displays an caller's address to a dispatcher when an emergency call is made.

Elvis Presley's Life Recalled

By DEAN POLING
Times Staff Writer

To some folks Elvis Presley never departed this Earth. After all if you jumble the letters in his first name, it does spell "lives."

Nonetheless, 13 years ago today, the reputed "King of Rock and Roll" died at the age of 42. Whereas tabloid headlines blaring "Elvis Lives!" marked the anniversary of his death during the past few years, this time the news is not so optimistic.

On the 13th anniversary, negative Elvis biographer Albert Goldman claims "the king" committed suicide, others claim he was murdered, and stories of a massive drug overdose have resurfaced.

But to some Valdosta-area folks that doesn't matter. Here are some of their memories of Elvis:

• Buddy Yow of Valdosta remembered the night the Roxy Theater opened. The show was "Elvis '38 Hawaii."

"I was right there on the front row," he said, craning his neck upward.

He also remembers working as a salesman at Langdale Ford when he heard the news Elvis died on Aug. 16, 1977.

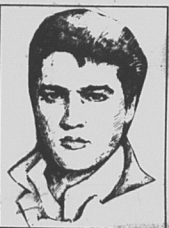
"This woman we worked with just sat in her chair and cried her eyes out," he said.

• Clyde Plair is a big Elvis fan, she says.

She was at home watching television when she heard Elvis died.

"It was very upsetting."

What made Elvis stand out was his music, his style," she said while working behind the counter at Yew's Men's Shop. "There was and is no one like him."



ELVIS PRESLEY

Excusing herself for just a minute, she went into the store's backroom to return with a musical Elvis "bound disc" of an animal and a mounted Elvis doll.

The doll stands on a stage which lights up while playing Elvis tunes. Bonnie Bickerton said she was an Elvis fan from the time he first started rockin' and rollin' back in the '50s.

While living in Alabama, I almost got to see him in concert but we couldn't make it. So we thought we'd see him next time but there was no next time."

She said his music, style, looks and personality are what made him a legend. Even her seven-year-old granddaughter, Dianna Little, thinks "he's a hunk," she said.

• Mary Reynolds was 10 years old when Elvis died but it didn't affect her.

See ELVIS, Page 2-A



Marchin' Cats

Valdosta High Marchin' Cats band members Maura Miller, Ginny Ferrell and Angellie Moore keep time during Wednesday morning's practice at Valdosta High. Both the Marchin' Cats and the Georgia Bridgemen of Valdosta City Limits of Bonita Road are gearing up for their upcoming season debuts. See page 10-B —Times Photo by Mike Tanner.

Crimebusters/A Weekly Look At Unsolved Crimes In Lowndes County

Schoolteacher Found Slain

By DEAN POLING
Times Staff Writer

Fourth-graders at Pine Grove Primary School were surprised when their teacher, Beverly K. Schappagh, entered their classroom in the brightly colored costume of a clown.

Students were studying a series of clown stories, and instead of merely giving a reading assignment, Ms. Schappagh added a dash of fun to the lesson. She wanted to make the series more "life-like."

A very dedicated teacher is how Ms. Schappagh's colleagues described her. She was the type of teacher who worked extra hours during the weekends.

Quite often, she spent those hours in her Pine Grove Primary classroom, a few miles north of the Valdosta city limits of Bonita Road.

Pine Grove Principal Bernard

Walden said that he had never seen her in a clown costume before.

The next day when a man, while walking his dog, passed by the school at about 6:45 a.m., Ms. Schappagh, 48, was lying in her gray 1987 Nissan Sentra. There was a bullet

wound in the left side of her chest. She already was dead.

Despite public interest in the case, local law enforcement officials remain stooped as to what exactly happened between the hours of that late Sunday night and early Monday morning.

At the end of June, Superior Court Judge Arthur McLean issued an unprecedented gag order to halt the flow of information on the case.

With rumors and speculations abounding in that community, law enforcement officials can neither deny nor confirm many reports.

Nonetheless, some facts are known in the case.

When Ms. Schappagh's body was found, her car was parked in an eastern corner of Pine Grove's playground. See CRIMEBUSTERS, Page 2-A.

Negotiators Reach PSC Deal

Staff, Wire Reports

ATLANTA — Negotiators have reached a proposed settlement on a rate dispute between Southern Bell and the Public Service Commission in which the telephone company would cut its profits by \$149 million a year while earning some profit beyond the previously authorized limit.

The settlement was expected to be filed with the PSC today. If approved, the proposal would end a court challenge of the PSC decision in June to lower phone company rates.

Ken Cooper, of Southern Bell's Valdosta office, told The Valdosta Daily Times Wednesday afternoon it was too early to tell if this will be the final solution.

"Every single item has not been

agreed to," said Michael Bradley, a special assistant attorney general who helped work out the deal between attorneys for Southern Bell and the PSC's consumer advocate staff and who outlined the package for the PSC Tuesday.

The PSC in June ordered Southern Bell to cut its rates to achieve a 118 million revenue reduction after finding that the company's profits had exceeded its authorized rate of court order to delay a rate cut which would have reduced monthly customer rates by \$2.75 per customer.

Under the proposed agreement, Southern Bell would agree to a \$149 million profit reduction for the current year, Bradley said, with up to \$40 million of that in reduced long distance rates. The rest of the

excess profit would be used to provide free countywide service to customers who now pay tolls for some local calls and for other purposes to be specified by the PSC.

Meanwhile, the PSC has been hearing testimony this week from Southern Bell's various independent telephone companies on the cost of providing free countywide calling, which was mandated by the Legislature this year. Residents of 128 of Georgia's 159 counties must now pay tolls for some cross-county calls.

The PSC staff presented four possible plans for free countywide calls, free calls within a 22-mile radius or slight variations. The greatest effect would be in Southern Bell. Bell would be asked \$43 million for eliminating intra-county tolls, according to the PSC staff.

Schoolteacher Found Slain

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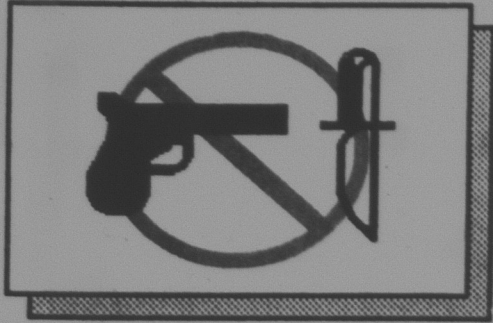
Students were studying a series of clown stories, and instead of merely giving a reading assignment, Ms. Schappaugh added a dash of fun to the lesson. She wanted to make the series more "life-like."

"A very dedicated teacher" is how Ms. Schappaugh's colleagues described her. She was the type of teacher who worked extra hours during the weekends.

Quite often, she spent those hours in her Pine Grove Primary class-

room, a few miles north of the Valdosta city limits off Bemiss Road.

Pine Grove Principal Bernard



Perry said Ms. Schappaugh was probably working at the school on Sunday afternoon, June 17.

The next day when a man, while walking his dog, passed by the school at about 6:45 a.m., Ms. Schappaugh, 48, was lying in her gray 1987 Nissan Sentra. There was a bullet

wound in the left side of her chest. She already was dead.

Despite public interest in the case, local law enforcement officials remain stumped as to what exactly happened between the hours of that late Sunday night and early Monday morning.

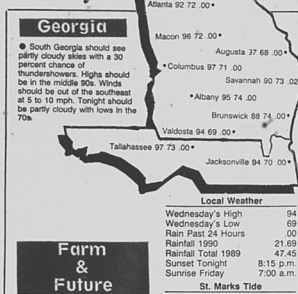
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See CRIMEBUSTERS, Page 2-A

Partly Cloudy

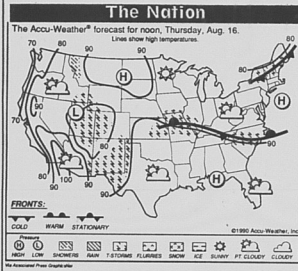


Farm & Future

● Farmers can expect scattered thunderstorms today through Thursday with amounts less than a quarter-inch. There should be eight to 10 hours of sunshine on both days.

● Georgia should see hot and muggy days with scattered showers and high winds in the high 90s and lows in the low 70s.

Rainfall For Month 3.56 inches
Rainfall For Year 21.69



The Region

Thursday, Aug. 16

● The national forecast calls for thunderstorms in parts of Alabama, Texas and New Mexico. The Rockies and parts of the Midwest.

● Coastal Georgia should see partly cloudy skies with high winds in the low 90s and lows in the lower 70s.

● Northwest Florida should see Friday with widely scattered thunderstorms. Highs should be in the 90s with lows in the low 70s.

Coast - To - Coast

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Crimebusters

From Page 1-A

ground. Next to her body, in the passenger seat, was a 38-caliber handgun.

The gun was registered under Ms. Schappach's name, but forensic and ballistics reports were not complete before the pag order.

Autopsy reports from the Georgia State Crime Laboratory in Atlanta show Ms. Schappach died from internal bleeding caused by a single gunshot wound in the area of her left breast.

The autopsy also revealed several minor injuries to her body. She had a black eye, a bruise on one of her shoulders and both knees were scraped.

Before the pag order was imposed, authorities were holding

McLane FUNERAL SERVICES

Ruby K. Snellgrove

Carolyn McLane Funeral Home
Martin/McLane Funeral Home
McLane Funeral Home
Clark Memorial
Riverview Memorial Gardens

Vadostans Use Water Conservation

By LAURA JOHNS
Times Staff Writer

Some Valdostans are beating the heat by water crisis with simple tips that anyone could practice.

Valdosta Mayor Jimmy Rainwater issued an emergency on the city's water supply last week and set up a water conservation committee. A water conservation system was implemented with showers, toilets, and even dish water to quench dry flower pots.

"We can't use any water that doesn't go down the drain," Mrs. Garber said.

Valdosta Becky Cavan also is doing her share.

a daily drink — without violating the city's emergency water restrictions.

The more we help the less the situation will become," said Valdosta Mayor Garber, who has lived in Valdosta where water restrictions were implemented.

When Mrs. Garber gets up her sink to wash dishes, she catches the water. Before it gets hot, in a container and uses it to water her plants. By using a mild soap to wash dishes, she saves water. After the dish water to quench dry flower pots.

"We can't use any water that doesn't go down the drain," Mrs. Garber said.

Valdosta Becky Cavan also is doing her share.

"my outside watering," Mrs. Cavan said. A sacker hose has no pump handles and lies on the ground to prevent water from evaporating like it does with a hose.

"I use a lot less water than a sacker hose," she said.

Valdosta State College students kept Henderson and Jim Garber conserving water by taking shorter showers and cutting off the water faucet instead of letting it run, while they brushing their teeth.

"With teenagers, it could really add up," Mrs. Garber said.

● Wash laundry in the tub.

● Put a brick or two in the tank of

toilet to displace water so that less is used with each flush.

● Cut back the time of sprinkler systems.

● Place water savers on shower heads.

● Check for water leaks both inside and outside.

● Keep a bucket in the shower to catch water that would otherwise go down the drain.

Mrs. Garber's children have learned to say "I will be" to the bucket in the city for her green outside plants because it appears she is saving water.

"If that happens, I'll take them to the store and show them the bucket I'm saving," she said chuckling.

Cook Works On Insurance Plan

By DEAN POLING
Times Staff Writer

ADEL — Health insurance for county employees was the focus of two proposals presented at a meeting of the Cook County Commission Wednesday and officials here hope one of the self-insurance plans will give them more control over the premiums and rates in the future.

Commissioner William "Smuffy" Smith said Monday evening's regular session the county commission hopes to choose one plan after months of insurance hunting.

He said proposals offered were not self-insurance plans but rather agreements between the county and an insurance company.

Smith said the self-insurance proposals offered, an insurance

company creates a management plan while the county collects premiums from employees and places the money in a reserve-fund pool.

When an employee files a claim, the county pays up to \$5,000 out of the pool, Smith said.

If a claim is more than \$5,000 then the employee must pay the rest of the claim. The pool is managed by an underwriter company covers the rest of the amount. The underwriter is provided by the insurance company as part of the management plan.

Smith said the management plans are designed for smooth transfer of funds and employees will never notice a difference in receiving their claims.

The County Commission began searching for a self-insurance plan after their current health-care insurance rates skyrocketed 44 percent

higher than last year's.

Even after commissioners set aside \$114,000 for employees insurance, it still wasn't enough. After the commissioners heard nearly a dozen proposals in the past two months, Smith said the self-insurance plan's premiums won't cost less than the current plan.

However, savings should be seen in the long run.

"It's not going to cut rates much," he said. "But we won't have to change companies every year either. We can work problems out on our own and learn more about what plan it should cost us in the long run."

Commissioners have caused the county commission to switch insurance companies several times in the past few years. This year's 40 percent increase came on top of last year's 39 percent increase.

Self-Hosting Officer Course

By LAURA JOHNS
Times Staff Writer

Valdosta State College Public Safety is hosting for the first time a self-training officer course for 17 area law enforcement agencies this month.

The course, to be held Aug. 27-31, is designed to teach police officers how to train and supervise their subordinates. The course is held after they complete training at the Georgia Police Academy, said Public Safety Director Ron Seacrest.

The college got quick responses to the course after advertising it through the regional Police Academy in Tifton.

"We had to turn several agencies down because the course filled up so quickly," said Ron Seacrest, Valdosta State College.

"We had to turn several agencies down because the course filled up so quickly," said Ron Seacrest, Valdosta State College.

"We have several agencies on a waiting list in case someone backs out," he said. "I think that will happen because this is a popular course."

Seacrest said different law enforcement agencies have sponsored the 40-hour course, which

field training officers need to be certified in order to lead.

The first time this college has sponsored it for law enforcement agencies, it was a success.

"We have the resources of VSC that other agencies do not have," Seacrest said. "The course may continue to offer the county a better way to train law enforcement agencies."

The course teaches "hands-on" training. Seacrest said the training Public Safety Crime Prevention Officer Bruce Holmes, who said the course is a "must" for all law enforcement officers, is the course organizer.

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Elvis

From Page 1-A

her until a year later.

There was a show about him on the local news anniversary of his death," she said. "It showed his entire life, and when it ended I cried."

Though she says she's not a "big Elvis fan," Ms. Reynolds admits he's "the sexiest man she's ever seen" on television.

● Lynn Bull, manager of Starship Records and Tapes, said Elvis' record during the

an Elvis anniversary, including the anniversary of his divorce, but this year's Elvis sales have been slow.

Tracy Harrison and Denver McEady, both employees of Camelot Music, said Elvis sales have been slow since then.

Obituaries

SARAH E. CONLEY

BOAIRE — Sarah Elizabeth Ganas, 65, died Tuesday, Aug. 14, 1990, at the St. Joseph's Hospital in Warner Robins after a lengthy illness.

Mrs. Conley, a native of Naylor, had lived in Bonaire since 1963, moving from Orlando, Fla. She was a former nurse aide at Hoxton Medical Center. She was the daughter of the late Joel Newton and Irene Griffin Ganas. Mrs. Conley was a member of the First Baptist Church of Bonaire, where she served as a member of the Black Girls in Action director.

Survivors include her husband, Paul Conley, five daughters, three sons, Barbara Griffin, Jeannette Fowler, both of Bonaire, Beth Burris of Staff, and Mrs. Lewis McEady of Macon; one son, Michael Conley, of Bonaire; and seven grandsons.

Funeral services will be held at 4 p.m. in the chapel of Lowry Funeral Home in Naylor. Burial will be in the cemetery of Naylor. Mrs. Conley was a member of the American Legion and was active in the church.

RUBY K. SNELLGROVE

Ruby K. Snellgrove ("Little Mama") of Valdosta, died Tuesday in South Georgia Medical Center after a short illness.

She was the daughter of Harris County, where she was a school teacher. She had resided in Valdosta for the past 50 years.

She is survived by her twin sister, Ruth K. Lynn; five daughters, three sons, C. Ogden, Jeannette S. Evans, Elizabeth (Lobby) S. Davis, Anne S. Linberger, all of Valdosta and Amy S. Bowers of Atlanta; three sons, Walter M. Snellgrove Jr., of Valdosta, Charlie K. Snellgrove of Bossier City, La., and Joe Snellgrove of New Orleans; 14 grandchildren; and 14 great-grandchildren.

Funeral services will be held today at 3:30 p.m. at the chapel of Carolyn McLane Funeral Home with Pastor Rex Lewis McEady of First Church officiating. Burial will be in Sunset Hills Cemetery.

Contributions to the American Heart Association or other charitable organizations will be appreciated.

MR. LODA B. WYERS

Mr. Loda B. Wyers, 75, died Tuesday, Aug. 14, 1990, at the St. Joseph's Hospital in Valdosta.

Mr. Wyers was a native of Fayette County. He was a retired cotton grower employee at Jasper Textile Company.

Survivors include his wife, Sarah Rowell Wyers of Lakeland, Fla.; two sons, James Wyers, Richard Wyers, both of Stockton and Philip Wyers of Jasper, Fla.; one daughter, Faye Easters of Jasper; one brother, James Wyers of Edgewater, Ala.; six sisters, Anna McDonald of Sheffield, Ala., Ethel Whitson, Adee E. Glatfelter, both of Winfield, Ala., Anna Howell of Elderday, Mary Cogdell and Blaine Smith, both of Atlanta; 15 grandchildren.

Graveside services will be held at 4 p.m. today, Aug. 16, in the Lowry Cemetery near Stockton. The Rev. Roy Bennett will officiate. Harry T. Reid Funeral Home of Jasper is in charge of arrangements.

Funeral services will be held at 4 p.m. today at the First Baptist Church in Bonaire. The Rev. Kenny Burris will officiate. Burial will be in Old Union Cemetery in Lakeland at 3 p.m.

McCallough Funeral Home of Warner Robins is in charge of arrangements.

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Crimebusters

From Page 1-A

ground. Next to her body, in the passenger seat, was a .38-caliber handgun.

The gun was registered under Ms. Schappaugh's name, but forensic and ballistic reports were not complete before the gag order.

Autopsy reports from the Georgia State Crime Laboratory in Atlanta show Ms. Schappaugh died from internal bleeding caused by a single gunshot wound in the area of her left breast.

The autopsy also revealed several minor injuries to her body. She had a black eye, a bruise on one of her shoulders and both knees were scraped.

Before the gag order was imposed, authorities were holding

her death certificate, saying it would not be issued until the cause of her death was determined.

Ms. Schappaugh was buried June 22.

She had just completed her first year teaching at Pine Grove Primary and was employed by the Lowndes County school system since 1979. She taught at Hahira Elementary School for 10 years.

Even though it is not customary to issue a gag order in a pending investigation, agreed State Attorney General Michael J. Bowers, he did say "a judge can issue an order in the interest of serving justice."

Anyone with information about the death of Ms. Schappaugh is asked to contact local law enforcement authorities.



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